

Connect your ESPN league

Six things out of your ESPN account and I can pull your league into the projections. It takes about five minutes, once, and there is a form at the end to fill in and send straight back.

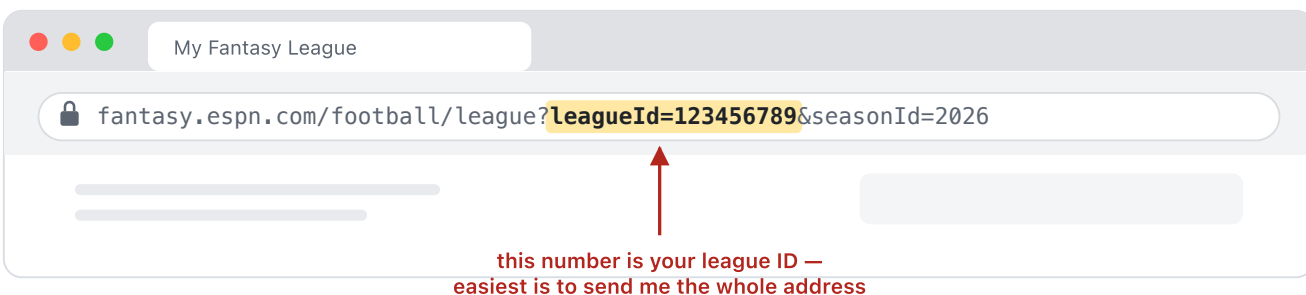
Before you start

You need **a computer** — laptop or desktop — **and the Chrome browser**. A phone cannot do this; the tool we need does not exist in the mobile app or in mobile Safari. Microsoft Edge works identically if that is what you have.

Log in at espn.com first and open the league you want connected, so you are looking at your own team.

1 Open your league and look at the address bar

With your league open, the web address at the top has a long number in it. That number is the league's ID. You do not have to pick it out — **select the whole address and copy it**, and I will take the number out of it.



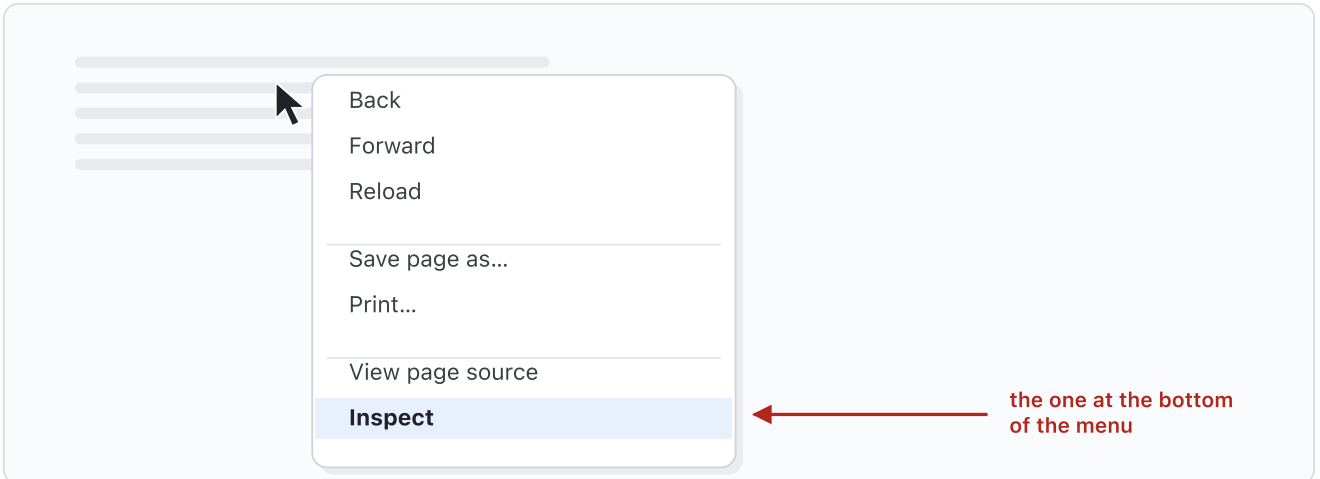
The address bar on any page inside your league. The number after leagueId= is the one that matters.

2

Right-click anywhere on the page, then click **Inspect**

Right-click on an empty part of the page — not on a link or an image — and a menu appears. **Inspect** is at the very bottom. A second panel opens beside or underneath the page; that is normal, and nothing you do in there changes your team.

If right-clicking does nothing, press `Option` + `Command` + `I` on a Mac, or `F12` on Windows.

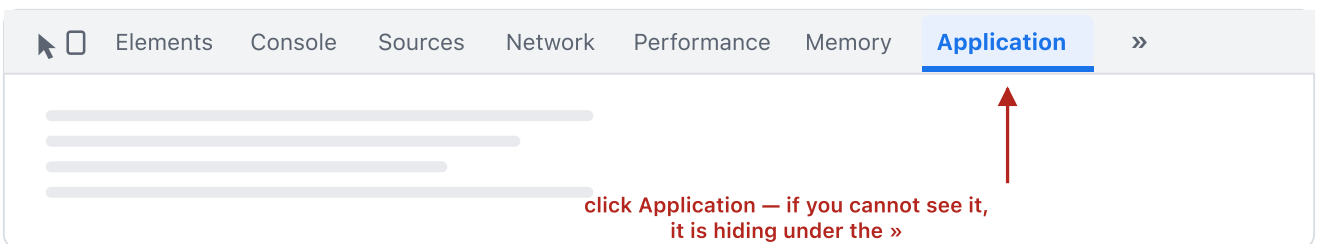


The right-click menu. **Inspect** is always the last item.

3

In that new panel, click **Application**

The new panel has a row of words along its top: Elements, Console, Sources and so on. Click **Application**. If you cannot see it, the row has run out of space — click the `»` at the end of the row and pick **Application** from the list that drops down.



The row of tabs across the top of the panel that just opened.

4

On the left, open Storage → Cookies → <https://fantasy.espn.com>

Down the left-hand side is a list. Find the **Storage** heading, click the little arrow next to **Cookies** to open it, and then click <https://fantasy.espn.com>. A big table fills the right-hand side.



The left-hand list, with Cookies opened up.

5

Find the row called SWID and copy its Value

The table is sorted alphabetically and it is long — scroll until you find **SWID** in the left-hand Name column. Copy what sits next to it in the **Value** column.

Copy the curly braces at each end as well. They look like punctuation but they are part of the value, and it will not work without them.

Name	Value	Domain
region	usa	.espn.com
s_ecid	MCMID%7C1938442	.espn.com
SWID	{A1B2C3D4-5E6F-7890-ABCD-EF1234567890}	.espn.com
espn_s2	AEBq7mXk%2FvR3TnGx...	.espn.com
noI_fpid	tt2xq9v0s1	.espn.com

copy the curly braces too — they are part of the value

It is a short code in the shape of a serial number, wrapped in { curly braces }.

6

Find the row called `espn_s2` and copy its Value

Same table, a different row: **`espn_s2`**. This one is much longer and has `%` signs scattered through it. Because it is too long to fit the column, **click the row once** and the whole thing appears in a panel underneath, where you can select it and copy it.

If you see a checkbox marked “Show URL-decoded”, leave it unchecked. Ticking it quietly rewrites the value and the connection will fail.

Name	Value	Domain
SWID	{A1B2C3D4-5E6F-789...	.espn.com
espn_s2	AEBq7mXk%2FvR3TnGxLd0pYzW8sCu1...	.espn.com
noI_fpid	tt2xq9v0s1	.espn.com

Cookie Value

AEBq7mXk%2FvR3TnGxLd0pYzW8sCu1JhNfA6QeDbMi5rKoP9t
5wQhTzVrB%2FnKdLp8XsYmE3aGc1UoJ9f

☐ Show URL-decoded

leave this box UNCHECKED — the %-signs have to stay in

Click the `espn_s2` row and the full value appears in the pane below.

7

Last thing: your name as ESPN spells it

My end matches you to your team by **manager name**, not by team name, and it has to match character for character — “Mike” and “Michael” are two different people to it. Open your league's **Members** page and tell me the name shown against your team, plus roughly what year the league started on ESPN.

Easiest of all: take a screenshot of that Members page and send it along. That answers the league name, your manager name and the spelling in one go.

League Members		
TEAM	MANAGER	
Thunder Cats	Jordan Ellis	this name, not the team name
Gridiron Gang	Sam Ortiz	
Waiver Wire Warriors	Alex Kim	

League → Members. The manager name is the one I need.

Send me these six things

All in one message is easiest — the two codes are no use to me one at a time.

The league's web address (*paste the whole thing*):

League name:

Your manager name, spelled exactly as ESPN has it:

First season this league was on ESPN (*a year, e.g. 2019*):

SWID (*with the { } braces*):

espn_s2 (*the long one*):

If something looks different

- **No `https://fantasy.espn.com` in the list.** Open your league page first, reload it, then look again. Failing that, click `https://www.espn.com` instead — the same two rows are in there.
- **The value looks chopped off.** It is — the column is too narrow. Click the row and copy from the pane underneath.
- **It worked and then stopped a few weeks later.** Expected. ESPN expires these on a schedule and I will ask you for a fresh pair; it is the same five minutes.

What you are actually sending me

Those two codes are the pass your browser shows ESPN to prove you are logged in. They are **not** your password, and they cannot be turned back into it — but while they last they do let me read ESPN as you, so treat them like a password: send them to me directly, not into a group chat, and do not post them anywhere public.

They expire on their own after a few weeks. If you ever want to cut them off sooner, change your ESPN password and both codes stop working immediately.

Any step that does not look like the picture, send me a screenshot of what you are seeing and I will point at the right thing.